

Scammed!

Characters:

Anirudh: Indian male about 26 year old

Entities: Unknown Humanoids

INT. ROOFTOP ROOM - EVENING

The scene opens with our main character taking a power nap on his desk. A Landline phone on his right. Mobile phone on his left.

His Mobile rings. He looks up and sees the caller ID: Supervisor sir

He jumps up, clears his throat and picks up the call.

SUPERVISOR

Hello! Anirudh, where are you? Tum abhi tak Clocked-in kyon nhi ho? 6:30 shift start hai na tumhara? Hello! Anirudh, where are you? Why haven't you Clocked-in yet? Your shift starts at 6:30 right?

ANIRUDH

Hello, Yes sir. Mai bus Clock-in kar hi rha tha. Thoda late ho gaya sorry.
Hello, Yes sir. I was just about to clock-in. Sorry, Got a bit late.

Starts fiddling with the PC

SUPERVISOR

Starting late on the first day itself? Please decide if you want to do this job or not. Because if the targets are not met you know there will be consequences, right?

ANIRUDH

Really sorry sir. I won't be repeating this sir. I want this job.

SUPERVISOR

You better not repeat this. There really won't be a second time. I will make sure of it.

ANIRUDH

I get it, totally. This is the last time this happened.

SUPERVISOR
We'll see. Regardless, before you start, let me make sure you know what you are doing, okay?

ANIRUDH
Sure sir. Please go ahead.

SUPERVISOR
Okay, what is your identity for this job?

ANIRUDH
I am Inspector Vijay from Cybercrime Division of National Investigation Bureau.

SUPERVISOR
Right, and you remember your training on how to use the Marauder Script?

ANIRUDH
Yes sir. It is really simple. I can handle it.

SUPERVISOR
Do NOT screw this up, with that overconfidence.

ANIRUDH
Of course not, sir. I am prepared.

SUPERVISOR
Fine... you may continue.

ANIRUDH
Sure sir. I will start right away.

Call Disconnects. Anirudh puts his phone down and Clocks-in. Then opens the CRM for the job.

Anirudh downloads a csv style file that lists targets for him for today.

ANIRUDH
Alright. Here we go.

Anirudh says to himself as he cracks his fingers. Pick the first target in the list. Dials the number using a CRM tool. The call connects after a few seconds.

ANIRUDH
Hello, main Inspector Vijaya bol rha hu National Bureau of Investigation ke Cybercrime Division se. Kya meri baat Mr. Sahaj Patel se ho rhi hai?

CALLEE

Ji mera naam hi Sahaj Patel hai.

ANIRUDH

Mr. Patel aap meri baat dhyaan se sunein aur call disconnect na karein. Isse pehle mai call ka reason bataun, mai aapse kuch basic details confirm karunga.

CALLEE

Hua kya hai bhai sahab?

ANIRUDH

Ye phone number 981000005 aapka hi personal number hai right?

CALLEE

Ji mera hi number hai ye.

ANIRUDH

Aapka address Ananda Vihaar, Noida ka hai.

CALLEE

Ji, par aap ye sab kyon mujhe bata rhe hain.

ANIRUDH

Patelji, ek investigation me ek overseas Bank account saamne aaya hai jisse ki aapka phone number aur PAN number linked hai.

CALLEE

(Voice raising)

Kya baat kar rhe hain? Kaun sa account? Mera koi overseas account nhi hai.

ANIRUDH

Sun toh lijiye poori baat. Humare records ke mutabik apka hi phone aur PAN number linked hai uss account se. And uspe 15 crore se jyada ke fraud transactions hue hain.

CALLEE

(Defensively)

Aise kaise maan le aapki baat. 15 crore koi majak hai? Itna bada amount aaj tak aaj tak dekha nhi humne, aap keh rhe hain mere account me hai?

ANIRUDH

Aapke inkaar karne se humare records nhi badal jaayenge Patelji. Filhaal toh investigation hoga uske baad hi pata chalega kitna doodh hai aur kitna paani.

CALLEE

Arre kya doodh paani kar rhe hain? Aap log aise kisi pe bhi, kuch bhi ilzaam laga denge? Koi system naam ki cheez hai ki nhi?

ANIRUDH

Dekhiye saara cheez system ke hisaab se hi hoga. Aapke naam ka Arrest Warrant issue hua hai jo aapke address pe Police lekar jaayegi. Uske baad poochtaach me aage ka khulaasa hoga.

CALLEE

(Getting Agitated)

Aise kaise arrest kar sakte hain mujhe? Matlab account hoga kisi mantri ke bete ka, aur mujhe sirf bali ka bakra banaya ja rha hai. Mere paas bhi licensi revolver hai, goli maar denge jo bhi faaltu arrest karne aayega mujhe.

ANIRUDH

Patelji, Patelji aap apna hi maamla kharab kar rhe hain. Ye call record ho rhi hai, samjhe aap?

CALLEE

(Highly Agitated)

Aur kitna kharab hoga maamla. Agar jail jaayenge toh murder ke liye jaayenge. Kisi aise jurm ke liye nhi jo humne kiya hi nhi.

ANIRUDH

Shaant ho jaayiye pehle aap thoda. Aur suniye meri baat.

CALLEE

Arre kya shaant ho jaaye? Aap ghatiya ilzaam lagaye ja rhe hain mere upar.

ANIRUDH

Patelji fir aap bole ja rhe hain. Meri baat sun toh lijiye pehle. Agar aapko lagta hai ki aapki identity ka misuse hua toh aap

(MORE)

ANIRUDH (CONT'D)
cooperate kijiye humare saath. Hum
secondary verification ka process
shuru kar sakte hain.

CALLEE
Haan, hua hai misuse. Hum aapko
dus baar bata chuke hain yahi
baat. Humara koi account nhi jisme
ye - 15 crore rakha hai.

ANIRUDH
Patelji mai aapse request kar rha
hu thoda thande dimaag se kaam
lijiye abhi. Mai samajh rha hu
identity ka misuse hua ho sakta
hai.

CALLEE
Ho sakta nhi, hua hai. Aur dimaag
aapne mera kharab kar rakha hai
aur bol rhe hain shaant rahiye.

ANIRUDH
Patelji ab jyada ho rha hai. Mai
aapko last oppertunity de rha hu,
aap cooperate kijiye humare saath.
Mai secondary verification ka
request abhi bhi daal sakta hu.

CALLEE
Ji mai shaant hu. Bataiye kya
karna hai.

Anirudh launches Marauder Script.

ANIRUDH
Aapka poora naam Sahaj Kumar Patel
hai, right?

CALLEE
Ji, Sahaj Kumar Patel.

ANIRUDH
Theek hai. Apna Data of Birth ek
baar bataiye mai record se match
karunga.

CALLEE
28 March, 1965

ANIRUDH
Theek hai, mai aapka phone number
confirm karunga. Aapko ek
verification code aayega aap usko
zor se padhiyega mai apne end par
check karunga. Samajh gaye?

CALLEE

Kaisa code?

Anirudh initiates Marauder Script

ANIRUDH

Aapke phone par aaya hoga check
kijiye please.

CALLEE

Han, aaya abhi. Six Four Seven One
One Five

ANIRUDH

Ji dhanyawaad Patelji. Aapke
records theek dikh rhe hain. Maine
secondary verification ke liye
application bhej diya hai. Aur
abhi ke liye aapka Warrant wapas
liya ja rha hai.

CALLEE

Abhi ke liye matlab? Parmanent
wapas hona chahiye na?

ANIRUDH

Parmanent wapas ho jaayega ek baar
verification ka process poora hone
dijiye. Aur abhi ke liye aap apna
phone switch off karke rakh
dijiye. Kyonki aapka number abhi
Tap hoga. Toh maamla aur
complicate na ho isiliye 1-2 din
ke liye koi call na kijiye na
uthaiye. Aur ye sab kisi se bhi
discuss mat kijiyeega.

CALLEE

Woh sab toh theek hai but mujhe
lag rha hai kuch toh gadbad hai.

ANIRUDH

Gadbad tha ab sab theek ho
jaayega. Abhi aap phone rakhiye
aur switch off kar dijiye. Samajh
gaye aap?

CALLEE

Baat kuch hajam nhi ho rha hai
mujhe.

ANIRUDH

Ho jaayega hajam. Aapka aur time
nhi lunga, isiliye shubh raatri.

CALLEE

Chaliye dekhte hain.

Satisfied. Anirudh hangs up. Marks lead as Collection in Progress. Celebrates quietly. And looks at the next lead.

He checks the number and enters it in the Dialer. Pauses for a second. Takes a deep breath and hits Dial.

CALLEE

Hello?

ANIRUDH

Hello, this is Inspector Vijaya
Speaking from the Cybercrime
Division of National Bureau of
Investigation. Am I speaking to
Mr. Gopiraj?

CALLEE

This is his son speaking. What do
you want?

ANIRUDH

May I speak to Mr. Gopiraj please?
This is really important.

CALLEE

(Sternly)

No, you may speak to me instead.
My father is busy at the moment.

ANIRUDH

Can I get your name please?

CALLEE

I am the President of India, go
ahead and google my name.

ANIRUDH

Hey, you better fix your attitude.
Your father is in deep legal
trouble and here your are trying
to be funny?

CALLEE

Oh really? What kind of legal
trouble is he in?

ANIRUDH

I think you didn't get me. This is
Inspector Vijaya from NBI,
Cybercrimes Division. We need to
contact your father regarding a
case that we believe he is
involved in.

CALLEE

Trust me I got you the very first
time itself. Usually, I don't
entertain fools like you but right
(MORE)

CALLEE (CONT'D)

now, I am intrigued. Please enlighten me on what kind of case is my dad involved in.

ANIRUDH

I am not obliged to share case details with you. But if you don't cooperate I will absolutely book you for interfering with a sensitive investigation involving National Security.

CALLEE

(Laughs loudly)

Go ahead, book me moron! Book me for terrorism instead and let me see what you are capable of.

ANIRUDH

(Getting angry)

Okay, wait and watch. It will take me minutes to find out your name from the records of your father. I am registering a case against you for interfering with an official investigation and obstructing a government officer. There will be a warrant out for your arrest soon along with your father. Then we will talk in person and see if you are still funny.

CALLEE

LOL! How thrilling! I am now the most wanted man in India just for being funny.

ANIRUDH

A silly reason to go in prison. All you had to do was cooperate with us. I am sure I will find your name in some other cases, all of which will be reopened now.

CALLEE

Great and I am sure I will find your name on Only Fans. How much you sell for? 20 Rs?

ANIRUDH

(Very angry)

Okay idiot! You have crossed the line. I will make sure that you regret it for the rest of your life.

CALLEE

Alright man. Go ahead, do whatever you want. But that's all the time I got for a clown like you. So now please go and bother someone else instead.

ANIRUDH

We are not done yet...

Call disconnects abruptly cutting Anirudh off. He mutters something to himself angrily while shaking his fist. He gets up and walks for a minute to release his frustration. Then returns to his workstation to mark the lead as failed. Checks another lead and hesitates for some time. His phone suddenly rings, with Caller ID: Supervisor Sir.

[Scene Note - Background Event]

[A strange hand is barely visible coming from behind an obstacle at a distance outside the window. Protagonist does not notice it or reacts to it. It is framed in a way that it's really hard to notice it. Stays for a few shots before disappearing. Always at the side or at the corner of the frame.]

SUPERVISOR

Hello Anirudh.

ANIRUDH

Yes, hello sir.

SUPERVISOR

I was reviewing your last call. What happened? You lost your cool too soon.

ANIRUDH

He already knew, sir. It was out of my hands.

SUPERVISOR

No Anirudh. Your approach was not correct. When he mentioned it's the son you should change tactics and find some reason to call back later or convince him to give phone to his father. But instead you doubled down on threats. You cannot lose your cool like this.

ANIRUDH

I understand sir. I will try my best.

SUPERVISOR

Don't sabotage leads like this. If you can't handle let us know. There is no shortage of people who want to do this.

ANIRUDH

No no, sir. And I promise I will be more careful.

SUPERVISOR

Consider this your final warning. You may continue.

ANIRUDH

Yes sir.

Anirudh takes a deep breath and starts calling the numbers. Call Montage begins.

INT. ROOFTOP ROOM - MIDDLE OF THE NIGHT

Anirudh looks at the Sheet and notices that there have been some modifications on it. He notices that some of the previous leads he had spoken to and marked as Collection in Progress have a strange note "DECEASED" next to them. He does not remember putting those.

ANIRUDH

What is this? When did I ever write this?

He scrolls up and down the sheet. He is confused.

INT. ROOFTOP ROOM - LATE NIGHT

Anirudh looks at the final entry in the Sheet. It says Anirudh G. He is shocked. He picks up his phone and calls his manager.

ANIRUDH

Hello sir.

SUPERVISOR

Yes Anirudh, what is it?

ANIRUDH

Sir, why is my name on this list?

SUPERVISOR

What do you mean? Why would your name be there in the list?

ANIRUDH

Sir, it says Anirudh G and has what looks like my number.

SUPERVISOR

So, you are telling me you are the only Anirudh G on the whole planet.

ANIRUDH

No sir, but it looks like my name and number.

SUPERVISOR

Why don't you call it and find out?

ANIRUDH

Sir, I have bad feeling about this.

SUPERVISOR

Listen, do me a favour. Just call all leads and submit the report. I don't have time for this.

ANIRUDH

Please sir, really strange things are happening. I am really scared.

SUPERVISOR

(Voice getting Garbled)
Anirudh just finish the list...
You need to finish the list...

ANIRUDH

What sir?

Call disconnects.

ANIRUDH

Hello? Hello?

Anirudh puts the phone down.

PHONE

(Garbled Voice)
Finish the list

ANIRUDH

What the fuck? What was that?

Scared, he looks around the room and the door. He gets up, picks up the door key and goes near the door. He tries opening but sees that the lock is on the other side of the door. He realizes he is trapped in the room.

ANIRUDH

Oh crap. What do I do? What the fuck!

Anirudh picks up his phone and dials Emergency number. Someone picks up on the other side.

SUPERVISOR

Hello, Anirudh? Why are you calling me again? Are you done with the list?

ANIRUDH

What? No sir! I didn't call you. I called Emergency no.

SUPERVISOR

Are you out of your mind? Why did you call Emergency? Something stupid going on in your mind?

ANIRUDH

No Sir! I am trapped in my room. I need help sir. I don't know what to do!

SUPERVISOR

(Voice getting Garbled)

I told you to finish the List...
Just finish the List...

Anirudh hangs up. He grabs his head in distress. He slowly approaches his PC. Then opens the dialer and types in the number. Hesitantly presses Dial.

Silence hangs for 15-20 seconds. Then his personal phone starts ringing. Caller ID says Unknown Number. Anirudh slowly picks up.

ANIRUDH

Hel...Hello?

VOICE

Hello, this is Inspector Vijaya
Speaking from the Cybercrime
Division of National Bureau of
Investigation. Am I speaking to
Mr. Anirudh?

ANIRUDH

(Panicking)

What? Who is this.

VOICE

This is Inspector Vijaya, I have
been assigned to your case file
regarding...

ANIRUDH

No no no, this is not possible.
This cannot be possible.

Anirudh drops his phone. Entities enter his room. Anirudh hides.

VOICE

Hello sir, am I audible? Hello?

Entities surround Anirudh, camera fades.

FADE OUT.